

Delaware County Commissioners Meeting May 18th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-cyMEhd7Zus
Publication Date	2026-05-19T05:22:41Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commission Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: May 18, 2026

Board: Delaware County Board of Commissioners

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Public Hearing on the Cumulative Capital Development (CCD) Fund [00:00:53](#).
- **Summary of Discussion:** Commissioners and staff outlined the purpose of establishing a Cumulative Capital Development fund, citing anticipated revenue reductions over the next 2 to 4 years due to upcoming local income tax (LIT) structural changes in 2029. Officials noted that 83 of 92 Indiana counties have this fund, which would be capped at a maximum rate (phased in over two years up to \$0.0333\$ per \$100) and primarily restricted to building maintenance and capital infrastructure. Citizens and local taxpayers heavily criticized the proposal during the hearing, expressing strong opposition due to recent dramatic property tax assessment hikes, fixed-income constraints, and general mistrust of government spending.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the regular meeting to order at 9:00 AM, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance 00:00:02.
 - **Attendance:**
 - Presiding Officer / Board President: [Not explicitly named in open roll call; referred to as Madam President]
 - Members Present: Commissioner Henry, Commissioner Brand, Commissioner Regan.
 - Members Absent: None.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening prayer/invocation (implied/omitted in transcript text) and Pledge of Allegiance led by the board 00:00:07.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Approved with a minor spelling correction for Batty Construction (Bridge 179 opening bids) on a motion by Commissioner Brand, seconded, and passed unanimously by voice/roll call vote 01:49:33.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 01:44:22 **Ordinance 2026-08: Capital Development Fund Ordinance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Following extensive public pushback during the public hearing, commissioners discussed the feasibility of moving forward.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Numerous residents spoke in opposition during the public hearing portion preceding this vote.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made not to act / deny the ordinance. Passed unanimously by roll call vote (Brand: Yes, Regan: Yes, Henry: Yes) 01:48:33.
- 01:50:01 **Cowan Community School Corporation Paving Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chris Connley / County Highway Superintendent Tommy.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The school district requested county highway labor assistance to pave roads in front of the high school, auxiliary gym, and local fire department, with the school covering all material costs and grinding fees.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Brand: Yes, Henry: Yes, Regan: Yes) subject to entering an interlocal agreement 01:54:27.
- 01:55:00 **Joint Resolution 2026-100: County System Modernization ("One-Touch Initiative")**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor Ed / OpenGov Representatives (Samantha, Ariel, James).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation by OpenGov regarding a centralized software platform integrating budgeting, asset management, and permitting to improve transparency and workflow efficiency.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved joint resolution pending County Council approval and funding authorization by roll call vote (Brand: Yes, Henry: Yes, Regan: Yes) [02:33:06](#). The underlying software contract itself was subsequently **tabled** pending Council review [02:47:07](#).
- **[02:33:24](#) Warranty Deed / Easement Approval (Bridge 103)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Engineer Dean.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Acceptance of a right-of-way easement on the southeast corner of Bridge 103 (500 North) for \$11,975 from budgeted funds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [02:34:21](#).
- **[02:34:34](#) Warranty Deed Approval (Bridge 179)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Engineer Dean.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Acceptance of a pre-paid parcel of right-of-way for Bridge 179 (Cornbread over Buck Creek) totaling \$7,340.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [02:35:04](#).
- **[02:35:10](#) 911 / EMA Office Buildout Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kyle / Director Cummings.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to construct two small offices in an unused foyer space at the 911/EMA building to accommodate new staff (GIS specialist), totaling under \$50,000.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved to be funded out of EDIT Fund 12 by roll call vote [02:40:03](#).
- **[02:40:20](#) Ordinance 2026-09 (Introduction): Traffic Ordinance Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal Counsel / County Engineer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of an ordinance to adjust speed limits on urbanized roads, specifically returning 26th Street (between Hoy and Tilton) from 20 mph back to 30 mph due to the former middle school closing. Commissioner Regan raised objections based on pedestrian feedback.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced for first reading, with a public hearing scheduled for June 1st, passed by roll call vote [02:44:12](#).
- **[02:47:36](#) Tax Rescission Petition: 613 North Broadway (Albany)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal Counsel.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Petition presented by the Treasurer, Assessor, and Auditor to rescind taxes on a tax-sale property acquired by the town of Albany for demolition and return to the tax base.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [02:48:57](#).
- **02:49:09 Joint Resolution 2026-101: Payroll Internal Controls & Segregation of Duties**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor Ed.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishment of formal internal controls and multi-level approval requirements for payroll.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved pending County Council approval by roll call vote [02:51:49](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: General citizen forum comments occurred during the statutory public hearing at the beginning of the meeting and during the conclusion). - [00:26:54 Paul Hovus](#): Questioned the necessity of the CCD tax given existing funds and expressed public mistrust regarding past tax usage. - [00:29:44 Dallas Hopkins](#): Expressed concern over high rental rates (48% of city residents are tenants) and lack of advance publication for the tax proposal. - [01:00:00 Cecil Bohannon](#): Analyzed tax cap implications and asked what tangible benefits taxpayers would receive for the increased cost. - [00:33:50 Cameron Grubs](#): Criticized the lack of transparency, short notice in the newspaper, and morning meeting time preventing working residents from attending. - [01:11:02 Christopher Bilbury](#): Objected to speaker sign-up requirements during public hearings and the timing of the meeting at 9:00 AM on a Monday. - [01:03:46 Donna Non \(Last name unclear/Donna\)](#): Spoke passionately against rising property assessments, insurance costs, and overall cost-of-living burdens on seniors. - [01:19:46 James McClure](#): Shared personal experiences with annual assessment appeals and criticized state-level cost tables. - [02:47:57 Rick Yensard](#): Inquired whether software providers utilize AI assistance and commended commissioners for listening to public concerns.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Purdue Extension update provided by Amanda Bullion regarding upcoming 4-H enrollment, STEM days, and financial literacy programs [02:56:32](#).
 - Plan Commission update provided by Kylen Swackhammer regarding the Unified Development Ordinance (UDO) RFP selection of American Structure Point [03:01:17](#).

- Bridge closure updates provided by Commissioner Brand (Bridge 51 and Bridge 112 schedules) [03:11:58](#).
 - Reminder of the upcoming flag-raising ceremony on May 24th at Old Town Hill Baptist Church honoring fallen Deputy/Corporal Blake Reynolds [03:16:01](#).
 - **Claims & Payroll:**
 - General claims approved (totaling \$26,921,517.77, largely driven by spring advance draws to local government units) [03:09:08](#).
 - Admin/legal claims approved (\$16,772.86) [03:09:32](#).
 - Payroll approved (\$1,090,066.36) with a warning from Commissioner Brand regarding manual sign-off procedures [03:10:17](#).
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to recess/adjourn passed by roll call vote at approximately 10:18 AM / end of transcript [03:17:54](#).
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